

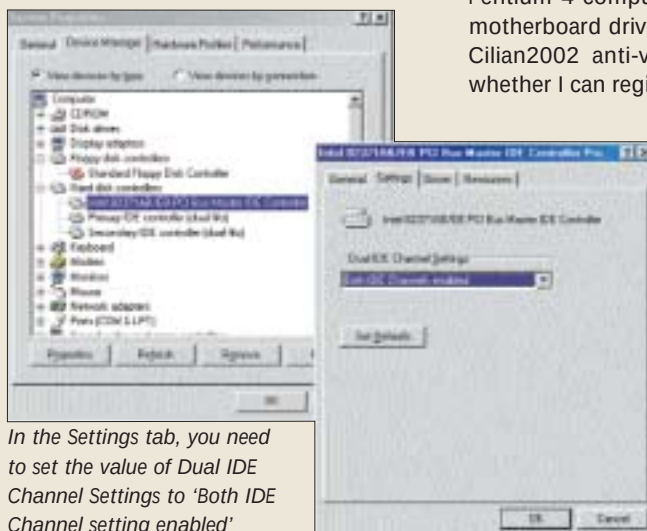
FAQs

Disappearing CD-ROM drive

Q I have a Pentium III 450 MHz processor running Windows 98. When I boot, my CD-ROM drive is detected, but later on the icon disappears. I reinstalled the OS, but the same thing happens again. What do I do?

Misbah Munnawer

A To solve your problem, right-click on My Computer and choose



In the Settings tab, you need to set the value of Dual IDE Channel Settings to 'Both IDE Channel setting enabled'

Properties. Go to **Device Manager > Hard disk controllers > PCI bus master IDE controller**, and click on Properties. Now, go to Settings and set the Dual IDE Channel setting to 'Both IDE Channels enabled'. Just click OK and restart the PC, and your problem is solved.

Legally free?

Q I recently purchased an assembled Pentium 4 computer for my home. The motherboard driver CD contains the PC-Cilian2002 anti-virus. I want to know whether I can register it with the company for upgrades and

latest anti-virus definitions. What is the legal position of this product?

Rajesh Kumar

A Don't worry, you stand on solid ground legally. You've purchased a hardware product that included software as part of the package. This

means that you've bought the right to use that software product as well. Therefore, you can go ahead and register on the Web site without any fear.

Internal modem in Windows XP

Q I have a 900 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM and a Motorola SM56 PCI 56 Kbps internal modem. This modem runs properly with Windows Me, but not with Windows XP. I get an error message saying, "Modem is not digitally signed". When I force the driver to install by clicking Continue, the modem does not work.

Abhay Rana

A To use your Motorola SM56 modem in Windows XP, you need to install the proper drivers. As Motorola has stopped its support for this modem, there aren't any certified Windows XP drivers available. First try the Windows 2000 drivers. Remove the modem from its current PCI slot, so as to completely delete the old driver files. Try any of the following drivers: http://modemsite.com/56k/_downloads.asp?dl=xflt/sm56/sm56xp8440.exe, <ftp://ftp.dell.com/comm/ZBRCFE11.EXE> or <http://www.motorola.com/softmodem/data-fax-voice.htm#DFVwinXP>.

A The answer's simple really—your floppy drive just died, or is too dirty to operate. First, clean the drive with a floppy drive cleaning disk. If this does not solve your problem, get the drive repaired, or just buy a new one.

MS-DOS programs refuse to run

Q I can't run DOS-based programs in Windows 2000. I was told that editing the system.ini file to show the following settings, works for Windows Me, 98 and 95:

[386Enh]

PerVMFiles=250

PerVMBuffers=40

ebios=*ebios

For Windows 95 or 98, the config.sys file was edited to reflect:

FILES=200

BUFFERS=40

What are the equivalent settings for Windows 2000?

Arif N Khan

A For running legacy DOS-based appli-

cations in Windows 2000, edit the 'config.nt' file located at **C:\winnt\system32\config.nt**. Add these attributes at the end of the text:

files=250

buffers=40

This will solve your problem.

Between dealer and compatibility

Q I have an Athlon XP 1700 on a KM133 DFI motherboard. Recently, I bought a GeForce2, but now all my games hang the system and the monitor flickers every few seconds. I went to the motherboard dealer, and he says it's a compatibility problem. Is he right? If he is right, then please tell me why this happens, as I have a 4x AGP slot. The dealer who sold me the GeForce2 card is not ready to take it back. What can I do?

Shantanu joshi

A Motherboards based on VIA chipsets generally have certain stability and compatibility issues that can be solved by installing the latest drivers.

First, download the Hyperion drivers

from www.viaarena.com. These are imperative for a stable system. Now, download and install the detonator drivers for your operating system from www.nvidia.com.

If the problem persists, set your card to lower speeds for more stability. Go into the BIOS, and in the 'Advanced Chipset Features', look for 'AGP Bus Speed' and 'AGP Aperture Size' and set them to the minimum level.

As a last resort, visit your motherboard manufacturer's Web site, download the latest BIOS update and flash your BIOS. Remember, flashing your BIOS is dangerous and may render your motherboard useless if not done correctly—preferably, get your motherboard dealer to do this for you. ■



sos@jasubhai.com
E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!